CITSABHA COLLECTIVE



SHUBHA NAGARAJAN SRIVIDYA ANGARA SINHA

SAMAAGATI

AN ODISSI-KUCHIPUDI JUGALBANDI

THE INVOCATION

GANAPATHI

CITSABHA COLLECTIVE



A short ode to the remover of all obstacles, opening the recital with humility and grace

The recital opens with a short invocatory piece dedicated to Ganapathi, the son of Goddess Parvathi. Revered across Indian culture as the remover of all obstacles, Ganapathi is invoked at thevery start of the performance, a gesture that seeks his blessing before the dancers step into the world of rasa that follows.

Set to the shared vocabulary of movement in both Odissi and Kuchipudi, this opening piece establishes the spirit of collaboration at the heart of Samaagati, with the two dancers moving in tandem to greet the divine.



THE CENTRAL PIECE — DEVARANAMA

KOLALANOODUVA

Krishna's flute stirs Vrindavana into enchanted chaos - a devaranama danced in two languages, weaving one story.

Kolalanooduva" is authored by the Kannada saint-poet Vyasaraja Teertha,
one of the foremost composers of the Haridasa tradition of devotional music. It speaks of Lord Krishna playing his flute in the groves of Vrindavana, and the enchantment bordering on chaos, that his melody stirs among all who hear it - the gopis, the cattle, and the very forest itself pauses to listen.

As the central piece of the jugalbandi, this devaranama allows both dancers to explore the same narrative through the distinct movement languages of Odissi and Kuchipudi, weaving together two traditions in service of a single, enchanting story.

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THE PIÈCE DE RÉSISTANCE

MEENAKSHI



An extraordinary birth. A warrior-queen. The divine mother of the universe.

Meenakshi, a 30-minute production is the concluding offering of Samaagati. This fitting finale both reveres and revels in the divine mother of the universe as Goddess Meenakshi of Madurai, consort of Lord Sundareshwara.

The piece traces her journey from her miraculous birth as a warrior born of fire, with three breasts (the third destined to vanish upon meeting her equal), through her conquests as a fearless queen, to her ultimate recognition as Goddess Parvathi Herself—bringing the jugalbandi to a triumphant close.

TOURING RECORD

SAMAAGATI

A decade-spanning collaboration between Odissi exponent Shubha Nagarajan and Kuchipudi exponent Srividya Angara Sinha — from a founding six-city United States tour to temple anniversaries, engineering-institute conferences, defence-research symposia, and grassroots outreach across India.

AN ODISSI–KUCHIPUDI JUGALBANDI

9 Years of active touring, 2017–2026

25+ Platforms presented across India and the US

6 Cities on the founding 2017 US tour

2022 Debut year of the concluding work, Meenakshi

2017

- **USA Tour** — FOUNDING TOUR
  Six-city United States tour — debut of Samaagati
- **SWARTAAL Music and Dance Festival** — Bengaluru

2018

- **Trimathacharya Gayatri Mandira, 30th Yr** — Gudibande, Chikkaballapur Dist.
- **Chandrachudeshwara Temple** — Hosur, Tamil Nadu
- **Biological Engg. Society Conference** — IIT Bombay

2019

- **Le Accueil — French Community** — Whitefield, Bengaluru

2020

Pandemic-related pause — no presentations on record.

2021

Pandemic-related pause — no presentations on record.

2022

- **Annual Fundraiser, Inner Wheel Club**
  NEW WORK: MEENAKSHI
  Bangalore IT Corridor

2023

No presentations on record.

2024

- **SVADHYAYA — Performing Arts Festival**
  HOSTED BY CITSABHĀ
- **Aurodhan** — Pondicherry
- **HarshTaal Cultural Festival** — IIT Dharwad
- **WITHIN** — CITSABHĀ COLLECTIVE
  Prestige Ozone, Whitefield
- **REACH OUT** — CITSABHĀ COLLECTIVE
  Shubham Karoti Maitreyi Gurukula, JP Nagar
- **Nritya Kala Sangama** — Natya Niketan / JSS Auditorium
- **ICSB 2024** — IIT Bombay

2025

- **ICoRD 2025** — IIT Hyderabad
- **Studio Showing** — Vid. Kalpana Kishore's space
- **Nochad Village Art & Culture Fest.** — Nochad, Kozhikode
- **Gayatri Mandira, 37th Anniversary** — Gudibande, Kolar
- **Kala Sangam, Studio Showing** — Sanjali Centre for Odissi Dance
- **Sri Sadhguru Sangeetha Sabha** — Vijayawada
- **VEDA Conference 2025** — DRDO, BEL Academy, Bengaluru
- **REACH OUT**
  CITSABHĀ COLLECTIVE
  Govt. HPS, Kotabagi, Dharwad
- **IEEE PESGRE Conference 2025** — IIT Dharwad

2026

- **Medai Marghazhi** — Bengaluru

MEDIA COVERAGE

SAMAAGATI

From its debut announcement ahead of a maiden United States tour to reviews of its Bengaluru premiere and its most recent incarnation as the concluding piece, Meenakshi, Samaagati has received coverage in national dailies, the Indian-American press, and specialist dance publications.

AN ODISSI–KUCHIPUDI JUGALBANDI

4 Publications covering Samaagati, 2017–2024

2 Countries — India and the United States

7 Years spanned, from debut tour to Meenakshi

SELECTED COVERAGE

THE INDIAN PANORAMA

24March2017 · NewYork

Kuchipudi–Odissi Jugalbandi by Bengaluru Dancers

Announcing Samaagati's inaugural six-city United States tour between 22April and 22 May 2017, this Indian-American weekly introduced the piece as *"taking steps together,"* tracing Shubha Nagarajan's Odissi training in the Bay Area and Srividya Angara's Kuchipudi diploma before their creative partnership, and previewing stops along the East and West coasts from New York to Los Angeles and San Francisco.

THE NEW INDIAN EXPRESS

10June2017 · Hyderabad

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

Hyderabadi Puts Samaagati on World Map

Profiling Srividya Angara Sinha on her return from the US tour, this feature traced how a conversation with a UCLA faculty member during a stay in Los Angeles sparked the idea of pairing Kuchipudi and Odissi, and how the collaboration came together with Shubha Nagarajan over months of choreography beginning in late 2016 — debuting in New York and closing the tour in Irvine.

THE HINDU

8September2017 · Bengaluru

SAMMITHA SREEVATHSA

Steps on the Same Path

Reviewing the Bengaluru premiere at Jagriti's Swartaal festival, this Friday Review piece called the collaboration *"a unique aesthetic,"* describing how the recital opened with a Ganesha stuti and moved through an Odissi Megh Pallavi, a Kuchipudi Shabdam, solo abhinaya in both forms, and a closing duet — noting how the shared classical grammar of invocation, pure dance and narrative let the two traditions meet on common ground.

NARTHAKI

7March2024 · Bengaluru

SATISH SURI

A Tapestry of Dance: Diverse Performances Take the Stage

Reviewing Citsabhā Collective'sSVADHYAYA festival at Seva Sadan, this dance-specialist publication described Samaagati as *"a musical dialogue"* between the two forms, following the narrative from a Ganesha invocation into Meenakshi's mythic arc — a fire-born warrior with three breasts who conquers every realm before her union with Sundareswara transforms her into the Goddess Parvathi — and highlighting how Kalaripayattu-inflected movement shaped the depiction of her strength and agility.

Coverage of Samaagati spans its earliest announcement as a touring concept through to its evolution into a full-length narrative work — a record of how the collaboration has been received by audiences and critics across two continents since 2017.

ODISSI EXPONENT · PERFORMER · COLLABORATOR

SHUBHA



Shubha in performance — photograph by *Madhusoodan SN*

AT A GLANCE

19+	Years of training and performance in Odissi
25+	Platforms that have presented Samaagati
6	Cities toured across the United States, 2017
10+	Years of community and charitable service

TRAINING

Nineteen years in the **Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra** style of Odissi, under **Guru Smt. Sharmila Mukherjee**

Workshops with Sujata and Ratikant Mohapatra, Aloka Kanungo, Daksha Mashruwala, Aruna Mohanty and Jhelum Paranjape

GRADED ARTISTE

- Graded B-High artiste, Doordarshan, Bengaluru
- Empanelled with SPICMACAY
- Sangeeth Bhushan, Pracheen Kala Kendra, Chandigarh

SELECTED PERFORMANCES

International Design Conference — IIT Hyderabad, 2025 · **Harshtaal Cultural Festival** — IIT Dharwad, 2024 · **Bangalore International Arts Festival** — Chowdiah Hall, 2021 · **Uttara Poorvi Evam Dakshini** — Sangeet Natak Akademi, 2016 · **International Odissi Dance Festival** — Bhubaneswar, 2015

COLLABORATION — SAMAAGATI

A six-city United States tour in 2017 with Kuchipudi dancer **Srividya Angara Sinha**, presented since on more than **twenty-five platforms**, including the 2022 production *Meenakshi*.

WORK WITH THE GURU

Lead role in *Sookshma*, a dance ballet by the **Sanjali Centre for Odissi Dance** adapting a Kannada folktale into classical form — contributing from script writing to costume design.

BEYOND THE STAGE

- **Co-founder, Citsabhā Collective** — a trust for the classical arts, host of the annual **Svadhyaya** festival
- Member, **Sarani — The Dance Collective**, Bengaluru

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KUCHIPUDI EXPONENT · EDUCATOR · SPEAKER

SRIVIDYA



Srividya in performance — photograph by *Madhusoodan SN*

AT A GLANCE

30+	Years of training and performance experience
500+	Performances worldwide
3000+	Students impacted through her Kuchipudi workshops
40+	Schools visited to demonstrate Kuchipudi

GOLD MEDALIST

Masters in Performing Arts, University of Hyderabad

Graded B-High artiste, Doordarshan, Bengaluru

DISTINGUISHED ALUMNI AWARDEE

Conferred by engineering alma mater, **VNR VJIET**

EDUCATOR

- **Guest Faculty** — IIT Hyderabad
- **GKF Visiting Fellow 2025** — IIT Kharagpur
- **Artistic Director** — Citsabhā Centre for Kuchipudi and Allied Arts
- **Empanelled artiste** with SPICMACAY

CHOREOGRAPHER

Created more than **twenty original works** in Kuchipudi

PATHBREAKER

Invited by the **Ministry of Youth Affairs** as *Pathbreaker* at the Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue 2025, New Delhi

ARTS AWARENESS

Co-founder, Citsabhā Collective— a not-for-profit arts organization

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